
HS 632: South Indian Epigraphy

Course Code	HS 632
Course Name	South Indian Epigraphy
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	Consent of the course instructor
Intended for	PG
Distribution	Elective for HSS
Approval	8th Senate (Oct 2015)

Course Contents

- The Modern Study of Epigraphy [7 Lectures]
 - Epigraphy and precolonial intellectuals
 - * The Mackenzie Project
 - * The Kavali brothers
 - * Narrain Row Brahmin and other Niyogi brahmal)as
 - James Prinsep
 - * The Brahmf script deciphered
 - * The KharO\$.fhf script deciphered
 - European Epigraphists
 - * Hermann Gundert
 - * B. Lewis Rice
 - * A.C. Burnell
 - * John F. Fleet
 - * E. Hultzsch
 - * James Burgess
 - * F. Kielhorn
 - * Fred Fawcett
 - South Indian Epigraphists
 - * R. Narasimhachar
 - * T.A. Gopinatha Rao
 - * Rao Bahadur V. Venkayya
 - * C.R. Krishnamacharlu
 - * R. Shamasastri
 - * K.V. Subrahmanya Iyer
 - * H. Krishna Shastri
 - * M.H.Krishna
 - The state and epigraphy publication projects
 - * Epigraphia Indica
 - * Epigraphia Carnatica
 - * Epigraphia Andhrica
 - * South Indian Inscriptions
 - * Corpus Inscriptionum Indicarum
 - * Travancore Archaeological Series
 - * Bulletin of the Rama Varma Research Institute
 - * Annual Report of the Mysore Archaeological Department
- The Brthimf Script [7 Lectures]

- Part- 1
 - Debates on the origin of Brahmi
 - Script and the Mauryan political praxis
 - The Weltanschauung of early Brahmi inscriptions
- Part- 2
 - Learning the Brahmi script
 - Deciphering select edicts of Asoka
- The Tamil Brahmi Script [7 Lectures]
- Part - 1
 - Trade, religion and the introduction of script in the Tamil country
 - Script and chieftain-polities
 - Agglutinative language-structure and the adaptation of Brahmi
- Part- 2
 - Learning the Tamil Brahmi script
 - Deciphering early Tamil cave labels
- The Kadamba Script [7 Lectures]
- Part- 1
 - Statecraft and land-grants
 - The context of agrarian expansion
 - Script-monopoly and the authority of eleemosynary establishments
- Part- 2
 - Learning the Kadamba script
 - Deciphering select inscriptions of the Kadambas
- The Vatteluttu Script [7 Lectures]
- Part- 1
 - The transition from Tamil Brahmi to Vatteluttu
 - The division of labour between the Vatteluttu and the Grantha scripts
- Part- 2
 - Learning the Vatteluttu script
 - Deciphering select Vatteluttu copperplates
- The Grantha Script [7 Lectures]
- Part- 1
 - Inflective language-use and the genesis of the Grantha script
 - Prasasti and the Grantha evolution
- Part - 2
 - Learning the Grantha script
 - Deciphering select Grantha inscription

References

(Selections from the following)

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2. Asher, Frederick M., and G. S. Gai (eds). 1985. Indian Epigraphy: Its Bearing on the History of Art. New Delhi: Oxford University Press and IBM/ American Institute of Indian Studies.
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4. Burnell, A.C. 1870. A Few Suggestions as to the Best Way of Making and Utilizing Copies of Indian Inscriptions. Madras: Higginbotham and Co.
5. . 1878. Elements of South Indian Palaeography. London: Triibner & Co.
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15. . 1996. Inscriptions of the Early Kadambas. New Delhi/Delhi: Indian Council of Historical Research and Pratibha Prakashan.
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